

Morotola sues Apple

Motorola has sued Apple for patent infringement to add to the ever growing web of law suits in the mobile industry

Google Latitude for desktop

Google has integrated latitude into the desktops as well
www.google.com/latitude

Cellphone

HOW WE TESTED

This test has two components to it - features and performance. The former is equal parts a listing of specifications and a checklist of features present/absent. Each phone is evaluated on the basis of build quality, ergonomics and usability. We rate both physical keypads and on-screen keypads similarly.

On the performance front, signal quality, clarity and integrity is on top of our priority list. We divide our testing of the signal quality, which is a look at the quality of internals like the antenna and baseband, into three zones. Zone one has maximum signal strength, zone two is indoors, whereas zone three represents the worst possible case of signal attenuation one can find. For zone three, we generally use a basement, or a region with bad reception. We also test the quality and loudness of the loudspeaker, as well as the quality of the bundled earphones. The camera and video capturing components are also tested and rated, as is the video playback, for which, the display is the major factor, along with the speed of processing. Bluetooth speed is measured by transferring an 11 MB file to the phone, via an Apple MacBook. For judging photo quality, we look for colour accuracy, noise and grain, and focussing. The display is rated on the basis of its colour, contrast and blackness levels.

CELLPHONES



Samsung S8500 Wave
Price: ₹20,000 (MRP)



HTC Desire
Price: ₹28,900 (MRP)



HTC Touch HD2
Price: ₹29,000

SPECIFICATIONS

Display: 3.3-inches; CPU: ARM Cortex A8 1 GHz; RAM: 2 GB; ROM: 512MB; Expansion: microSD; Camera: 5 Mega-pixel; Battery: 1500mAh

Display: 3.7-inch; CPU: Qualcomm QSD8250 (1 GHz); RAM: 576 MB; ROM: 512 MB; Expansion: microSD; Camera: 5-megapixel; Battery: 1400 mAh

Display: 4.3-inch; CPU: Qualcomm QSD8250 (1 GHz); RAM: 448 MB; ROM: 512 MB; Expansion: microSD; Camera: 5-megapixel; Battery: 1230 mAh

TEST CENTRE RATINGS (All Scores out of 10)

Features.....7.5

Great AMOLED display and camera. Lack of QWERTY keypad is a big minus

Performance.....7.0

The Wave is a decent performer with an impressive audio and display quality. Quick and responsive touch interface.

Build quality.....8.0

The Wave is solidly built with an all-metallic body and incorporates a human body curve design.

Value for money.....7.0

At ₹20,000, it burns a deep hole in your pocket. Still, it makes a decent buy.

Features.....8.0

Great interface, sublime display, and top notch hardware for a phone.

Performance.....8.0

Fast CPU and great overall hardware. Poor battery life and loudspeaker distorts. Keypad performs accurately.

Build quality.....7.0

The Desire is well built, and looks quite stunning. Plastic battery cover looks cheap - it's only minus in this test.

Value for money.....7.0

₹28,900 isn't cheap, but the Desire is a lot of phone for what you pay.

Features.....7.0

Huge display and a pretty decent platform that Sense UI makes better.

Performance.....7.5

Snappy, but not as snappy as the HTC Desire. Good camera and surprisingly good battery life for large display.

Build quality.....7.5

Built like a tank, with a solid metal battery cover. The extra large display might not survive a drop though.

Value for money.....6.0

Price is expensive as WM 6.5 is archaic and HD2 is simply an old timer now.

WE SAY

7.5

The Samsung Wave has a no frills user interface. The solid build quality and design aesthetics provide good value for money. Good multimedia performance adds the icing on the cake.

7.5

Desire is one of the best Android phones. Superb display, touch interface, hardware and looks. Battery life and loudspeaker could be better. Worth it if you want something light yet powerful.

7.0

Good phone but better options available. Unless you must have a 4.3-inch display right now, wait. Touch response and display are better on Desire. We say wait for HTC's WP7-based handsets.

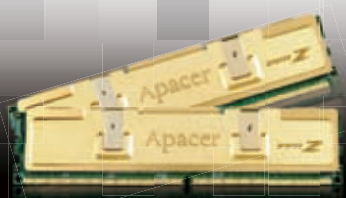
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